DECISION IN ONE VIEW

Protect wanted SIP continuity without pushing an unwanted payment

Increase the percentage of first-time mutual fund investors who still have an active SIP 12 months after starting their first one.

The investor-good outcome is an informed, affordable choice. A deliberate pause may be right even when the metric falls.

Research bet

A previously working AutoPay can become repeated manual repair for someone who still wants to contribute. The writer may consider moving platforms.

Product bet

Help the person distinguish a bank debit, the Groww order, a manual workaround, and the following scheduled SIP.

Evidence boundary

The next-cycle outcome and month-12 effect are not established. This is a testable hypothesis.

Brief; public account and capability sources in AI Evidence Log, 9 Nov 2026.

One investor, many SIPs: the metric is an OR across plans

N = A + I + U

Eligible first-SIP starters at their month-12 checkpoint

A: ≥1 successful SIP in prior 30 days | I: none confirmed | U: unresolved

1 · Chosen plan

Amount/date and mandate fit the person's intent.

2 · Due and attempt

A wanted instalment reaches a valid payment attempt.

3 · Final order

SIP-linked success is confirmed; debit alone is insufficient.

4 · Continuity

Recovery or informed change; any plan can qualify at month 12.

Possible lift = 100 × (net eligible people whose month-12 status changes) / N percentage points. Both the numerator and N need Groww data.

Guardrail: an informed pause is not a failure to "fix"; another successful SIP can make a single-plan repair valuable to the user but neutral to the NSM.

Brief NSM definition; PART2_4_CURRENT_DECISION_2026-11-09.md. All Groww cohort values unknown.

CURRENT PRODUCT AND COMPETITOR CHECK

A new pause button is not the uncovered need

Groww already offers controls

Skip an upcoming instalment, edit a SIP, and check order and AutoPay help. The skip rule depends on timing.

Coin also offers controls

Official Coin help documents modify, pause and delete. Feature parity alone is not a reason to build.

Observed user work

A Groww writer reports manual investing, contacting both bank and Groww, and trying a new mandate after repeat failures.

PM inference

The gap worth testing is not “can I pause?” It is whether a person can tell what happened this cycle, what remains unresolved, and what to expect at the next due date.

Rivals: bank/rail execution may be the only problem; existing Groww help may already answer the question. We have not observed the live in-app flow for this cohort.

Groww skip, AutoPay and order help; Zerodha Coin modify/pause/delete help (official pages, checked 9 Nov).

PART 1 · DISCOVERY ENGINE

The engine turns public accounts into questions, not population rates

932
app review IDs retrieved

100
public voice rows saved

9/9
source-linked readings

4
unscored problem leads

Collection → SIP relevance and duplicate screen → event/action/outcome proposal → source check → answer with rival + unknown.

Starts and expectations

People describe different goals; a later reassessment does not prove a bad start.

Changes and interruptions

Skip, reduction, manual catch-up and continued payment are different outcomes.

What remains weak

Checking frequency, quiet drop-offs, segment rates and month-12 success are not visible publicly.

No denominator connects retrieved reviews to first-time Groww investors. The answers guide research; they do not measure churn or choose a solution.

Open the nine-question engine

SIP Lens snapshot and AI Evidence Log, 9 Nov 2026. Different counts have different units.

BEHAVIORAL EVIDENCE

The same “missed SIP” signal can mean three different things

Unwanted repair

AutoPay worked for months, then repeatedly failed. The writer invested manually, contacted the bank and Groww, and tried another mandate.

Next scheduled success unknown.

Same-cycle recovery

One of several SIPs debited. The writer manually paid the others, so a single failed plan cannot be equated with a stopped investor.

Manual catch-up ≠ future AutoPay.

Informed adjustment

A writer skipped a month, paid the next and considered reducing the amount. The desired plan changed without all investing ending.

A skip ≠ lost intent.

Contrast rule: capture intent → triggering event → action → this-cycle order → following scheduled order → other SIPs. Keep reported reason separate from our driver hypothesis.

These selected posts show possible mechanisms and counterexamples. They are not representative, verified transaction records or a count of first-year drop-offs.

Public account links and paraphrases in the AI Evidence Log; first-ever-MF and month-12 outcomes unverified.

Five behavioral situations; choose a testable burden, not the loudest complaint

Situation	Observed signal	What could change	Strong rival
Automation-reliant restorer	**Repeats manual repair**	**Clarify next payment**	**Bank/rail fault**
Budget recalibrator	Skip → pay → reduce	Fit new amount	Correct pause
Schedule interpreter	Asks effect of edit	Understand next due	Help suffices
Early-return reassessor	Concern; continues	Interpret horizon	No payment gap
Externally guided starter	Friend shaped start	Own decision logic	Circumstance changed

Decision: test the repeated-repair task. The reported burden is concrete and Groww can influence the information hand-off. Reach, severity across the cohort and month-12 lift are unknown; the choice reverses if current help already resolves it.

Written survey narrowed the claim; it did not validate the chosen mechanism

9
submitted

5/8
of 8 participation-eligible tried SIP

1
broad cohort screen fit

0/5–6
incident interviews

Eight survey-eligible = 4 completed SIP + 1 setup-only attempt + 3 never attempted. Among five attempters: 1 no prior MF, 3 prior MF, 1 unsure.

Why this method?

A past, specific due-date incident can separate intention, action and result. A general opinion about SIPs cannot.

Same neutral prompts

Ask what they expected, what changed, what Groww and bank showed, what they did outside the app, and what happened next.

What we learned

One broad-fit answer mixed a long-term goal and early-profit expectation. It challenges a payment-only story, but gives no next-payment episode.

Required contrast still absent: a strict-cohort unwanted interruption beside a comparable continuer or informed pause. Mock interviews would not close that gap.

PART 4 · PROBLEM DEFINITION

The burden is observed; the cause and retention impact remain hypotheses

When a previously working SIP fails, a person who still wants to contribute may repair this month manually yet remain unsure whether the next scheduled debit will work.

User job

Know which payment fact is confirmed, avoid a duplicate action, and carry a precise question to official support.

Product outcome

Correctly distinguish bank debit, completed SIP order, this-cycle workaround and following due status.

Business path

If a wanted next SIP succeeds for a person otherwise inactive at month 12, the NSM may move. Net reach and lift are unknown.

Causal fork to test: unclear cross-actor status adds repair work | bank/rail still fails despite perfect explanation | current help already suffices | another SIP keeps the person active.

The product cannot create money, repair a bank, certify a payment or turn an informed pause into a failure.

Groww/Reddit sources in Evidence Log; FINAL_PROBLEM_BOUNDARY_2026-11-09.md.

A two-cycle check earns AI only if it beats a fixed guide

A · Existing help

Accurate official rules. The person must still choose a page and connect a bank debit, SIP order, manual payment and next AutoPay themselves.

B · Fixed SIP Check

Six choices produce a safe this-cycle and next-cycle answer without AI. Trade-off: the person must classify mixed messages themselves.

C · AI-assisted Check

AI could read mixed wording into six proposed facts; code rejects conflicts and the person corrects them. Benefit must beat B without added errors.

What the customer sees

“Bank debited; Groww processing” becomes: this order is not yet confirmed; check its expected completion date. The following scheduled SIP stays unknown. No duplicate payment is suggested.

B is live. C is coded but held after failed extraction diagnostics. Same-task test: correct facts and official check, unsafe directions, effort and corrections. If B works as well, prefer B.

Try the customer-facing SIP Check

MVP contract and live prototype. Concept comparison is designed, not user-tested.

Do not call a prototype task a 12-month retention result

Task comparison

Give the same real payment-understanding task to current help, fixed check and gated AI. Record unassisted result and corrections.

Leading indicators

Correct status understanding / completed tasks; correct official route / tasks; wanted next-SIP success / intended dues.

Guardrails

False completion or duplicate-pay direction → unknown + official check. Bank fault → support route. Retention pressure → informed-pause guardrail.

Future investor-level experiment

Randomize eligible investors, not SIPs. Compare next scheduled success and intent match before the mature cohort reaches month 12. Report A/N and unresolved U/N; preserve one-versus-many SIP status.

RICE = reach × impact × confidence / effort. It is not numerically rankable: reach, incremental impact and confidence are unmeasured. AI quality needs supported-field recall, unknown preservation and severe-error counts on ~20 independent labels. Interviews: 0/5–6; target-user tasks: 0/3.

Read sources, arithmetic and AI corrections in the Evidence Log

Brief; CONTINUITY_MAP_EVAL.md; AI Evidence Log. User task tests and human golden-set scoring outstanding.